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MUSEUM COLLECTIONS MANAGER - VERTEBRATE ANIMALS

About College of Environmental Science and Forestry:

Founded in 1911, the State University of New York College of Environmental Science and Forestry (ESF) is the nation's oldest and most respected school dedicated to the study of the environment, developing renewable technologies and building a sustainable future. The ESF main campus is in Syracuse, NY and has regional campuses throughout Central New York and the Adirondack Park. ESF consistently earns high rankings in US News and World Report, Forbes, Peterson's Guide, The Washington Monthly, Princeton Review and other national college guidebooks.

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Category:	Professional
Department:	Environmental Biology
Locations:	Syracuse, NY
Posted:	Jul 21, 2021
Closes:	Open Until Fille
Type:	Full-time
Position ID:	133917

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Job Description:

Campus Title: Collections Manager, Vertebrate Animals

Unit: Department of Environmental Biology

Professional Rank and Salary Range: SL4, Salary DOQ

Brief Description of Duties:

The State University of New York College of Environmental Science and Forestry (ESF) in Syracuse, NY invites applicatic for a calendar year position as an Instructional Support Specialist, serving specifically as the Collections Manager within Department of Environmental Biology. The successful candidate will be in charge of the physical care, maintenance, accessibility, specimen preparation, and preservation of the College's vertebrate collections and their associated data, housed within the Roosevelt Wild Life Collections (RWLC). These research and teaching collections are primarily compo: of birds and mammals, but also fishes, amphibians, and reptiles. The Collections Manager will promote and support use collections for educational and research purposes, maintain specimen and loan records, and respond to information anc loan requests. The Collections Manager will provide technical assistance for collections-related fund-raising, exhibitions, and other tasks associated with specimens and their data. The Collections Manager will also recruit, train, and supervise diverse student interns, volunteers, and researchers in museum techniques, cooperate with faculty across the College tc address their collections-related teaching and research needs, and participate in a professional outreach capacity to promote the use and importance of the RWLC for natural history education.

- Position workload: 40% collections management, 30% records administration, and 30% education and outreach
- Provide knowledge on vertebrate taxonomy, morphology, and natural history as appropriate to the RWLC, for the purposes of collections management, vertebrate preparation, education, and outreach (including handling extension calls)
- Employ best practices in the physical care, maintenance, specimen preparation, preservation, protection, organization, pest management, import/export, acquisition, and strategic growth of vertebrate collections. Some of these duties can include knowledge and proper use of chemicals and their disposal
- Stay current on relevant regulatory laws and compliance procedures related to vertebrate collections, and maintain any permi relevant to the RWLC
- Ensure meticulous record keeping and data accessibility
- Manage multiple projects and their progress in an organized fashion
- Work on extended, iterative tasks (e.g., data entry) with minimal supervision
- Use computer as an important collections tool, including word processing, spreadsheets, data entry, file organization, digitizat imaging, and data archiving
- Use and modify a relational collections database (especially Specify open-source collections database software) to enter, retri and organize specimen data
- Recruit, train, and supervise collections interns, volunteers, researchers, student teaching assistants, faculty, and staff in prop specimen and data handling and related museum techniques
- Seek ongoing collections improvement (e.g., data and specimen accessibility and interpretation, physical infrastructure, workf
- Keep collections spaces and equipment clean, tidy, pest-free, and in working order, addressing any issues in a timely manner
- Cultivate specimen acquisition, including specimen exchanges, donations, and field collections or salvage, to address strateg needs, in consultation with Head Curator
- Effectively and professionally communicate with members of the college and the public (both written and oral)
- Foster a positive and cooperative working environment with undergraduate and graduate students, staff, and faculty from dive backgrounds
- Teach a course in museum techniques, focused on vertebrate animals and specimen preparation
- Work with faculty and students to identify collections-based research projects; Collections Manager may also participate direc in research related to collections
- Keep abreast of current collections trends, issues, and best collections practices, including biodiversity informatics being an active member of the Society for the Preservation of Natural History Collections (SPNHC)

Requirements:

MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS

- Master's degree in a natural science or museum collections field or related field, and
- Three years of work experience in the natural sciences or natural science museum collections, or a combination of these
- Computer competency to include word processing, spreadsheet software, and file organization (Word, Excel and Access)

Physical mobility requirements:

- Able to handle specimens and operate tools or controls, reach up to 96 inches high (via step stool or ladder), climb (stairs, ladders, stepstools) and physically maneuver in area to perform job duties
- Able to lift and/or move up to 25 pounds

PREFERRED QUALIFICATIONS

- Proficiency in vertebrate taxonomy, morphology, and natural history, especially within the northeastern United States,

- Working knowledge of relevant regulatory laws and compliance procedures related to collections, particularly vertebrat collections

- Previous work experience involving day-to-day management of collections

- Demonstrated proficiency with standard natural history database systems, (e.g. Specify, Axiell EMu, Symbiota, Arctos), and/or computer programming experience highly desired

- Working knowledge of external data repositories such as Global Biodiversity Information Facility (GBIF), iDigBio, and MorphoSource

- Demonstrated organizational and project management ability

- Experience writing effective reports, grants, professional correspondence and/or procedure manuals

- Demonstrated proficiency in presenting information to and responding to questions from individuals or groups of managers, scientists, and the general public

- Demonstrated interest in collections improvement (including but not limited to data and specimen accessibility and interpretation, physical infrastructure, and workflow)

- Demonstrated potential for engaging diverse students in the classroom or as a research or museum techniques mento

- Demonstrated commitment to diversity, access, and in fostering an inclusive environment

- Demonstrated potential for identifying and developing collections-based research projects at the high school, college, and/or graduate level

- Membership in SPNHC, and relevant vertebrate-based society memberships

Additional Information:

Pursuant to Executive Order 161, no State entity, as defined by the Executive Order, is permitted to ask, or mandate, in form, that an applicant for employment provide his or her current compensation, or any prior compensation history, until such time as the applicant is extended a conditional offer of employment with compensation. If such information has be requested from you before such time, please contact the Governor's Office of Employee Relations at (518) 474-6988 or email at **info@goer.ny.gov**

In accordance with the Jeanne Clery Disclosure of Campus Security Policy and Campus Crime Statistics Act" institution higher education are required to prepare an annual report containing information on campus security policies and campu statistics. This report includes statistics for the previous three years concerning reported crimes that occurred on-campu in certain off-campus buildings or property owned or controlled by SUNY-ESF; and on property within, or immediately adjacent to and accessible from the campus. The report also includes institutional policies concerning campus security, such as policies concerning sexual assault, and other matters. You can obtain a printed copy of this report by contactin SUNY-ESF University Police at 315-470-6667 or by accessing the following web site: **http://www.esf.edu/univpolice/crimereports/**

SUNY ESF is a Smoke and Tobacco Free campus and is dedicated to providing a healthy and safe environment for the entire campus. For more information you can visit our Tobacco and Smoke Free Policy at **https://www.esf.edu/au/documents/ESF Tobacco Free.pdf**

SUNY-ESF is an equal opportunity/affirmative action employer. All qualified applicants will receive considerat for employment without regard to sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, race, color, religion, national origin disability, protected veteran status, age, or any other characteristic protected by law.

Application Procedures should submit application materials by **August 4, 2021** and contact Amy McLaughlin, Associate Director of Human Resources to request early consideration.

Application Deadline: Although applications will be accepted until the position is filled, candidates should submit their application by **August 30, 2021**, to ensure optimal consideration.

Application Procedure: Application materials are required to be submitted on-line at http://www.esf.edu/hr/. Please provide the following in a single PDF file in this order: 1) a Cover Letter explaining interest and summarizing qualification (three pages maximum), 2) Curriculum Vitae, 3) a two-page Collections Statement, and 4) at least three employment references (we will not contact references without prior permission). In your Collections Statement, please address BOT of the following: 1) why natural history collections are important, and 2) a recent advance or issue in the collections field and how it applies to and is important for the RWLC. Questions about the application process and document submissio should be directed to the Human Resources office.

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Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ's)

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